

José Luis Illana Ruiz

Distributed Systems & Observability Architect | Senior Software Engineer | Banking & Regulated Environments

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Professional Summary

Software architect and senior software engineer with professional experience since 2008. Specialized in distributed systems, observability architecture, and monitoring platforms for banking and regulated environments.

His experience combines cross-functional technical leadership, resilient and scalable architecture design, software development, and quality governance. He has worked across cloud-native and on-premises platforms, real-time ingestion systems, Go backends, Elasticsearch, time-series platforms, and Java and Scala environments.

Specialties

- Software architecture and distributed systems.
- Observability architecture and monitoring.
- High-volume, real-time ingestion platforms.
- High availability, multi-region strategies, and resilience.
- Technical leadership and alignment between teams and business needs.
- Software quality, CI/CD, TDD, and BDD.
- AI-assisted Spec-Driven Development (AI SDD).
- Harness Engineering.

Professional Experience

BBVA Technology in Europe

Principal Platform Architect (Technical Lead) - Monitoring & Observability Platform BBVA

January 2020-present

Cross-functional technical lead for the design and evolution of Monitoring & Observability Platform BBVA, a monitoring and observability platform developed entirely by BBVA.

- Defines architecture, quality standards, and strategic technical decisions for cloud-native and on-premises platforms.
- Focuses systems on resilience, scalability, and operational efficiency in support of critical banking services.
- Leads complex technical decisions, aligns multiple teams, and translates business needs into sustainable architectural solutions.
- Defines horizontally scalable distributed architectures for high-volume, real-time ingestion.
- Designs multi-region and high-availability strategies.
- Makes architectural decisions involving Go backends, Elasticsearch, time-series platforms, and infrastructure.
- Establishes secure-communication standards using TLS and mTLS.
- Governs CI/CD and quality practices, including TDD and BDD.
- Performs final technical validation before production.
- Leads critical-incident resolution and resilience improvements.
- Prevents long-term technical debt through architectural risk assessment.
- The platform processes more than one million ingestion operations per second in real time, combining individual requests with bulk loads containing hundreds or thousands of items.

BEEVA - now BBVA Technology

Big Data and Backend Developer

November 2014-December 2019

BEEVA belonged to the BBVA group throughout this period and later changed its name to BBVA Technology. This experience forms part of one continuous trajectory at the same company since November 2014.

- Big Data architecture and development.
- Java and Scala programming.
- Participation in several proofs of concept for clients external to BBVA, including Ferrovial.

Reporting Operacional

An internal BBVA project conceived as an observability and reporting platform for banking procedures.

- Contributed to development of the project architecture.
- Developed the service layer.
- Developed ETL and analytics capabilities with Pig and Hadoop.

Indra

Java Analyst Programmer

April 2012-November 2014

Direct continuation of the assignment begun through Grupo Arelance, with Telefónica as the final client. The work covered approximately 50-60 applications used internally by Telefónica and maintained and evolved by Indra.

- Analysis, estimation, development, and maintenance of Telefónica corporate web platforms and backend services.
- Primarily Java development, analysis and design of new technical requirements, and framework selection according to project needs.
- Participation in Java projects containing modules developed with Flex and Flash.

Grupo Arelance

Java Programmer

February 2010-April 2012

Through Grupo Arelance, worked on a subcontracted assignment for Indra, with Telefónica as the final client. In April 2012, Indra hired him directly and the work continued in the same assignment context.

- Java programming, analysis and design of new requirements, and use of frameworks selected according to project needs.
- Participation in projects with Java architecture and modules developed with Flex and Flash.

Efeso Consulting

Java and Flash Programmer and Systems Administrator

2008-2010

- Java development.
- Flash development.
- Linux system and Oracle database administration.

Education

I.E.S. Las Fuentezuelas

FP II, Software Application Development

2005-2007

IPFA Jaén

Science Baccalaureate

2005-2006

Professional Training and Credentials

AI Foundations

- OpenAI Academy.
- Completed professional training; Course Completion Certificate.
- Issued July 6, 2026.
- Verification: <https://academy.openai.com/public/certificate/kqzb9iz7kf>

AI Expert

- DevExpert.
- Completed online professional training on June 20, 2026.

LFS148: Getting Started with OpenTelemetry

- The Linux Foundation.
- Completed professional training with a verifiable credential.
- Credly credential type: Learning.
- Credly level: Foundational.
- Issued March 30, 2026.
- Verification: <https://www.credly.com/badges/0061c2f0-fb46-43b0-a03d-edfccbc898de>

Big Data on AWS

- Completed company-provided professional training through Qwiklabs.
- Earned August 30, 2015.
- Verification: https://www.skills.google/public_profiles/390c5a9b-0a9d-489a-9a02-d14065b7eed4/badges/997

Solutions Architect - Associate

- Completed company-provided professional training through Qwiklabs; this does not imply possession of an official AWS certification.
- Earned August 17, 2015.
- Verification: https://www.skills.google/public_profiles/390c5a9b-0a9d-489a-9a02-d14065b7eed4/badges/919

Skills

Architecture, Systems, and Operations

- Software architecture.
- Distributed systems.
- Observability.
- Monitoring.
- Time-series platforms.
- CI/CD.
- TDD and BDD.
- TLS and mTLS.

Development and Data

- Go.
- Java.
- Scala.
- Elasticsearch.
- Pig.
- Hadoop.

Systems and Databases

- Linux system administration.
- Oracle database administration.

AI-Assisted Software Engineering

- AI-assisted Spec-Driven Development (AI SDD).
- Harness Engineering.

Languages

- Spanish: native.
- English: professional working proficiency; comfortable holding conversations, especially on professional workplace topics.